

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 964

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Pope's Garden Center on the occasion of its fiftieth anniversary.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing those exemplary businesses that, through an abiding commitment to excellence, have contributed greatly to this State for many years; and

WHEREAS, Pope's Garden Center is one such esteemed enterprise, which celebrated its fiftieth anniversary in 2025, a commendable milestone for this family-owned, independently run business; and

WHEREAS, founded in 1975 by Robert "Bubba" Pope, Pope's Garden Center began as a modest operation focused on growing and selling vegetable plants, with its roots in the wholesale market and a dedication to quality horticulture; and

WHEREAS, through perseverance and entrepreneurial spirit, the business expanded from its early beginnings to include greenhouse operations and retail garden centers, establishing a strong presence in the Knoxville and Maryville areas; and

WHEREAS, over the decades, Pope's Garden Center has remained a family-owned and -operated business, with three generations of the Pope family contributing to its continued success and upholding its founding values of hard work, integrity, and customer service; and

WHEREAS, today, Pope's Garden Center operates multiple garden centers and plant farms in East Tennessee, including locations in Maryville, Greenback, and Knoxville, while continuing to serve both retail customers and wholesale partners; and

WHEREAS, the business has demonstrated a remarkable ability to adapt to changing market conditions, evolving from a primarily wholesale operation to a thriving retail presence while maintaining its commitment to locally grown products and personalized service; and

WHEREAS, Pope's Garden Center has played an important role in the local economy by providing employment opportunities and supporting the agricultural and horticultural traditions of the region; and

WHEREAS, deeply rooted in their community, the Pope family and their employees take pride in serving their neighbors and contributing to the quality of life in East Tennessee through their dedication to excellence in gardening and plant cultivation; and

WHEREAS, for fifty years, Pope's Garden Center has exemplified what it means to be a family-run business, standing as a testament to the enduring strength of family enterprise and the value of commitment to one's community; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Pope's Garden Center upon the celebration of its fiftieth anniversary and extend to its owners and employees our best wishes for many more years of continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.